OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

PILGRIMAGES TO MEDJUGORJE & LOURDES 2027 Deposits and Savings scheme available on Thursdays in Parochial House from 10.30am-12noon.beginning in October. contact Margaret 07732468511

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel: Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION WORKSHOPS November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

GIFT AID We are about to claim our Gift Aid for the tax year ending April 2026. If you are a member of our Gift Aid Scheme and have stopped paying tax please get in touch with the parish office to let us know as soon as possible. If you pay tax and would like to join our Gift Aid Scheme please get in touch with the parish office. Thank you to all who have joined the Gift Aid Scheme

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community: Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18–35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7:30pm, starting 20 October, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org.

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99



Sun 18th Oct 2026 Vol 44 No 42

MASSES
Saturday Vigil 6.00pm
Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm
Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS
Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm
Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm
Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS
Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES
Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE
71267070
1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ
Email:office@holyfamily-parish.com
Website: www. holyfamily-parish.com
Webcam: Click on website and follow the links
Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

GIVING TO GOD OR GIVING TO CAESAR

They must really have thought they had their victim sewn up! If Jesus said he paid the Roman taxes, he recognised the Emperor, not God, as his Lord. If he said he didn't pay, he was a traitor to Rome. Jesus turns the question back on them. First he makes them admit that they themselves recognise Rome as overlord by carrying a Roman coin, for the coin would carry the Emperor's head. Next he puts them a question: what do they consider is due to Caesar?

Finally he goes beyond their question, to interrogate their ultimate loyalty: in the last analysis, just what is due to God? At a superficial level this seems a little verbal tussle, in which Jesus outwits his opponents. But the story was remembered and passed on in the Christian community not because of Jesus' cleverness, but because at a deeper level it is a question which Jesus puts to each of us: just where do our loyalties and priorities lie? Money? Respect? Fame? A good holiday? Comfort? Power?

Jesus is not a dictator who imposes his will. He just asks the question and leave us to give our own answer. To those who question him he gives no easy answer, but always replies with another question.

HOLY FAMILY PARISH DRAW

Our Parish Draw will begin in January 2027 to provide funds for the refurbishment and future capital needs of our Parish. We sincerely hope that the draw will be as successful.

It will run from 1st January 2027 to 31st December 2027 and, if our target number of subscribers is met, the monthly prizes will continue to be £1,000, £500 and £250 for a monthly subscription of **£10 by standing order or cash payment of £120 for year.**

A subscriber to the Draw must be at least 18 years of age.

Registration for the Parish Draw will be open from 1st November 2026 and close on the 17th January 2027. If you would like to help to sell or promote tickets please come to a meeting on Wednesday at 7.00pm in the parish office.

SYMPATHY We offer our sympathy to the family of Ciaran Norrby, Lindenwood Park who died during the week. May he rest in peace.

BAPTISM Our parish family welcomes: Noah Conri McEleney Allingham Close.

NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF PERPETUAL HELP will begin on Tuesday 27th November.

MASS for parishioners who have died during the past year will take place on Wednesday 4th November and Thursday 5th November at 7.15.

ROSARY ON THE COAST. Rosary on the Coast will be at 3pm today Sunday at Benone We will pray for unborn children. Tel 077303 30028

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Frank Quinn, Eddie & Rosaleen Keogh, Mary & Kevin McFeeley, Tina Keys, Bernadette Munster, Kieran, John & Annie Mongan,

SUNDAY COLLECTION 4th October £2256.44 & €220.70 Standing Orders £400 **2nd Collection** £1121.30 & €79.06.. Thank you for your generosity

HOLY FAMILY SCRIPTURE GROUP meets on **Thursday at 6.00pm** in the Upper Room This is a sacred time to come together to listen and reflect as Jesus speaks to each of us through His Word in scripture All welcome

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction."

LEGION OF MARY meets on Wednesday evenings at 5.45pm. Anyone willing to do Our Lady's work is asked to call Patricia on 02871417867

THORNHILL MINISTRIES will lead an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way that will help participants let the Word of God to nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. '*Open heart - Open to the Word'* series of Sundays in October 3:30 - 4:30 pm Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church. All welcome

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION COURSES January 2027 to March 2027 are now online for booking. The courses can be booked on the website www.accordni.com All of these courses are in person.

JAN 29th/30th FEB19th/20th MAR 19th/20th 2027.

CATHOLIC MARRIAGE ENCOUNTER WEEKEND St. Mary's, Knock, Co. MayoFriday 9th to Sunday 11th April 2027 This residential Weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie